

Proficiency in English - I

An exhaustive academic monograph investigating the historical, sociological, and constitutional status of English in India (Lord Macaulay, Wood's Despatch, Kothari Commission, Official Languages Act), its role as a global lingua franca (Braj Kachru's Three Concentric Circles), the psycholinguistic architecture of a print-rich classroom, listening comprehension models, English phonetics and phonology (the 44 IPA phonemes, vowels, diphthongs, consonants), supra-segmental dynamics (word stress, stress-timed rhythm, intonation contours), spoken discourse pedagogy, critical reading strategies (skimming, scanning, intensive, extensive), textual discourse analysis across four genres, the Three-Phase Reading Model, Kenneth Goodman's Miscue Analysis, lexical categorization (open vs. closed word classes), morphology and affixation processes, and semantic relationships (homophones, homonyms, synonyms, idioms, and collocations).

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Curriculum Session 2026 • Exhaustive Master Reference Edition

SYLLABUS ARCHITECTURE & MODULE WEIGHTAGE

Total: 35 External Marks

Unit 1

5 Marks

Status of English

Colonial History, Kachru's Concentric Circles, Constitutional Mandates (AOL), and the $L_1/L_2/FL$ Continuum.

Unit 2

10 Marks

Oral Discourses & Phonology

Print-Rich Ecologies, IPA 44 Phonemes, Word/Sentence Stress, Stress-Timed Rhythm, and Classroom Theatre.

Unit 3

10 Marks

Critical Reading Strategies

Skimming, Scanning, 4 Text Genres, Three-Phase Instructional Reading, and Kenneth Goodman's Miscue Analysis.

Unit 4

10 Marks

Word Architecture & Lexicon

Open vs. Closed Classes, Derivational/Inflectional Affixation, Compounding, Homophones, and Collocations.

1

Status of English in India and the Global Landscape

Historical Trajectory, Global Lingua Franca, Constitutional Status & The $L_1/L_2/FL$ Continuum

Weightage: 5 Marks

1.1 Historical Trajectory: From Colonial Instrument to National Empowerer

Historical Evolution

The presence of English in the Indian subcontinent represents an intricate sociolinguistic journey spanning more than two centuries. It arrived not through natural folk convergence, but as a deliberate political instrument of British imperial rule. Over the decades, however, the language has been indigenized, appropriated, and reshaped by Indian citizens into a vital instrument for democratic empowerment, legal advocacy, inter-state administration, and international mobility.

● MACAULAY'S MINUTE (1835)

Lord Thomas Babington Macaulay formulated the imperial policy aiming to cultivate "*a class of persons, Indian in blood and colour, but English in taste, in opinions, in morals, and in intellect*" to serve as administrative intermediaries.

Policy: Downward Filtration Theory

● WOOD'S DESPATCH (1854)

Referred to as the "*Magna Carta of English Education in India*". Recommended establishing universities (Calcutta, Bombay, Madras) with English as the medium for higher learning, while recognizing vernacular primary schools.

Policy: Higher Ed Institutionalization

● RADHAKRISHNAN COMMISSION (1948)

The first post-independence university education commission. Strongly cautioned against hasty abandonment of English: "*English is a window through which we can see the scientific and technological advancements of the world.*"

Policy: Library Language Concept

● KOTHARI COMMISSION (1964-66)

Formalized the Three-Language Formula (R_1, R_2, R_3). Affirmed that English must serve as an essential **link language** between states and the central union, as well as a window to global knowledge.

Policy: Link & Library Medium

1.2 & 1.3

English as a Global Lingua Franca & Positioning in the School Curriculum

Sociolinguistics

Braj Kachru's Three Concentric Circles of English:

Linguist Braj Kachru categorized the global diffusion of the English language into three distinct demographic and functional spheres:

1. The Inner Circle (Norm-Providing):

Native English-speaking nations where English is the primary mother tongue (L_1): UK, USA, Canada, Australia, New Zealand ($\approx$ 380 million speakers).

2. The Outer Circle (Norm-Developing):

Post-colonial multilingual nations where English functions as an institutionalized second language (L_2): India, Nigeria, Singapore, Ghana, Philippines ($\approx$ 300-500 million speakers).

3. The Expanding Circle (Norm-Dependent):

Nations without colonial English history where English is learned as a foreign language (FL) for global trade, science, and tourism: China, Japan, Germany, Brazil ($\approx$ 1 billion learners).

Sociolinguistic Reality: Today, non-native speakers of English in the Outer and Expanding circles significantly outnumber native speakers in the Inner Circle by a ratio exceeding 3 : 1!

Positioning English in NCF 2005, NEP 2020 & NCF-SE 2023:

National policy has shifted the pedagogical posture towards English from exclusionary elitism to democratic access:

- **From Elitist Gatekeeper to Democratic Right:** NCF 2005 emphasized that English must no longer function as a socio-economic barrier dividing urban elites from rural masses; all children deserve communicative exposure.
- **Additive Multilingualism under NEP 2020:** Early schooling prioritizes the mother tongue or home dialect (L_1) as the medium of instruction until at least Grade 5. English is introduced concurrently as a communicative subject without displacing the home tongue.
- **Communicative Competence Goal:** Modern curricula reject rote grammar rules, translation memorization, and spelling drills. The overarching objective is authentic spoken fluency, conversational confidence, and reading comprehension.

1.4 &
1.5

**Constitutional Status of
English & The**

L_1 / L_2 / **Foreign Language
Continuum**

Legal & Theoretical
Architecture

Under **Article 343** of the Constitution of India, Hindi in Devanagari script was declared the Official Language of the Union. The framers originally stipulated that English would continue to be utilized for official transactions for only 15 years (expiring in 1965). However, strong linguistic anxieties voiced across non-Hindi southern and northeastern states led Parliament to pass the **Official Languages Act of 1963 (amended in 1967)**, establishing English as the indefinite **Associate Official Language (AOL)** of India.

EVALUATIVE FEATURE	FIRST LANGUAGE (L_1 – MOTHER TONGUE)	SECOND LANGUAGE (L_2 – ENGLISH IN INDIA)	FOREIGN LANGUAGE (FL – E.G., FRENCH, GERMAN)
1. Natural Environment & Acquisition	Subconsciously acquired from birth within the domestic family and immediate neighborhood.	Acquired and learned in classrooms and institutional environments supported by public environmental print.	Learned strictly in formal classrooms with negligible social exposure outside the school gate.
2. Societal Presence	Language of emotional intimacy, domestic routines, and regional cultural identity.	Pervasive on signboards, mobile apps, television, banking, administrative documents, and news.	Zero organic presence in daily street transactions or domestic home conversations in India.
3. Primary Motivational Utility	Basic human survival, socio-emotional attachment, self-concept formulation.	Academic advancement, national administration, employment opportunities, and inter-state trade.	International diplomacy, specialized translation, and foreign tourism.

Pedagogical Lesson for Elementary Educators:

In Assam and across India, English is a **Second Language (L_2)**, never a Foreign Language (FL). Because English surrounds young children on shop packaging, vehicle number plates, and mobile devices, teachers must treat this environmental familiarity as a learning asset rather than teaching English as a dry, dead subject.

2

Understanding Language: Oral Discourses & Phonology

Print-Rich Ecologies, IPA Sound Inventory (44 Sounds), Supra-segmentals & Discourse Pedagogy

Weightage:
10 Marks

2.1 & 2.2 The Language-Rich Classroom & Cognitive Models of Listening Psycholinguistic Foundations

Language is an interactive human capacity. Children cannot acquire proficiency in sterile, silent classrooms where only the teacher lectures from the blackboard. Early primary classrooms must be designed as **Language-Rich and Print-Rich Environments**:

● THE PRINT-RICH PHYSICAL ECOLOGY

Every physical surface in the primary classroom acts as an instructional aid. Low display shelves, bilingual object labels (Table / মেজ, Door / দুৱাৰ), classroom message boards, thematic word walls, and accessible pictorial storybook corners immerse the child in visual text.

When children see their own drawings and scribbled stories mounted on walls at eye-level, their sense of linguistic authorship and self-worth expands significantly.

● HEARING VS. LISTENING WITH COMPREHENSION

Hearing is a passive, involuntary physiological phenomenon occurring when sound vibrations contact the tympanic membrane without active cognitive engagement.

Listening is a conscious, voluntary cognitive operation requiring selective attention, auditory discrimination, acoustic decoding, syntactic parsing, and contextual meaning extraction.

● DUAL COGNITIVE MODELS OF LISTENING PROCESSING

Bottom-Up Processing (Acoustic Decoding):

Decoding speech linearly from the smallest phonetic components upward:

Phonetic Sounds → Words → Phrases → Grammatical Clauses → ~~World Knowledge~~ + Contextual Clues → Anticipation → Holistic Interpretation

Trained through minimal pair discrimination and phonics exercises.

Top-Down Processing (Schema-Driven Inferencing):

Using prior background knowledge, cultural context, and situational cues to predict and construct meaning:

Trained through story predictions, picture discussions, and contextual riddles.

Unlike transparent phonetic scripts (such as Assamese, Bengali, or Devanagari, where graphic letters map directly to sounds), English features an opaque, non-phonetic orthography. The 26 letters of the Roman alphabet must articulate approximately 44 distinct phonemic sounds in standard Received Pronunciation (RP):

● THE 20 VOWEL SOUNDS: MONOPHTHONGS (12) AND DIPHTHONGS (8)

VOWEL CATEGORY	PHONEMIC SYMBOLS	ILLUSTRATIVE WORD EXAMPLES
Short Monophthongs (7)	/ɪ/, /e/, /æ/, /ʊ/, /ʌ/, /ʊ/, /ə/	sit, bed, cat, hot, cup, book, about (the schwa)
Long Monophthongs (5)	/i:/, /a:/, /ɔ:/, /u:/, /ɜ:/	seet, father, door, moon, bird
Centring Diphthongs (3)	/ɪə/, /eə/, /ʊə/	near, hair, tour
Closing Diphthongs (5)	/eɪ/, /aɪ/, /ɔɪ/, /əʊ/, /aʊ/	day, sky, boy, go, now

● THE 24 CONSONANT SOUNDS (VOICED VS. VOICELESS TYPOLOGY)

ARTICULATORY MANNER	VOICELESS (NO VOCAL FOLD VIBRATION)	VOICED (VOCAL FOLD VIBRATION)
Plosives / Stops	/p/ (pin), /t/ (tin), /k/ (cat)	/b/ (bin), /d/ (din), /g/ (gun)
Fricatives	/f/ (fan), /θ/ (think), /s/ (sip), /ʃ/ (ship), /h/ (hat)	/v/ (van), /ð/ (this), /z/ (zip), /ʒ/ (measure)
Affricates	/tʃ/ (church)	/dʒ/ (judge)
Nasals, Liquids & Glides	None (All sonorant consonants are voiced)	/m/ (man), /n/ (net), /ŋ/ (sing), /l/ (lip), /r/ (red), /w/ (wet), /j/ (yes)

The Diagnostic Tool: Minimal Pairs Drill

Minimal pairs are word pairings differing by only one single phoneme: ship /ʃɪp/ vs. sheep /ʃi:p/, pen /pen/ vs. pan /pæn/, fan /fæn/ vs. van /væn/. Using minimal pair contrast drills in primary classrooms directly corrects regional dialect interference.

The Prosodic Triad: Stress, Rhythm & Intonation:**1. Word and Sentence Stress:**

Syllables produced with greater breath force, pitch elevation, and duration. Stress alters word class:

Noun: 'CON-duct ↔ Verb: con-'DUCT

Noun: 'OB-ject ↔ Verb: ob-'JECT

2. English Rhythm (Stress-Timed):

English intervals between stressed syllables remain uniform regardless of how many unstressed syllables intervene. In contrast, Indian languages are **syllable-timed** (every syllable receives equal duration). Indian students must be guided into rhythmic stress pulsing.

3. Intonation Contours:

- **Falling Tone** (↘): Declarative facts, commands, Wh-questions ("Where are you going? ↘").
- **Rising Tone** (↗): Polite requests, Yes/No questions ("Are you ready? ↗").
- **Fall-Rise** (↘↗): Nuanced reservation, warning, or polite correction.

Classroom Theatre, Storytelling & The Fluency Balance:

Children develop spoken competence through communicative performance rather than textbook interrogation:

• **Classroom Theatre & Role Play:** Enacting character roles behind cloth puppets or mask props dissolves adolescent stage anxiety and invites authentic spontaneous dialogue.

• **Oral Narratives & Retelling:** Listening to rich teacher storytelling followed by student narrative retelling in their own creative words develops narrative sequencing and causal logic.

• **The Fluency vs. Accuracy Dilemma:** In the early foundational stage, educators must prioritize **Fluency over Accuracy**. Interrupting a child's spontaneous expression to correct minor preposition or tense errors causes affective mutism and anxiety!

Critical Reading, Comprehension & Textual Discourse

Reading Modes & Sub-skills, Four Discourse Genres, Three-Phase Reading & Goodman's Miscue Analysis

Weightage:
10 Marks

READING STRATEGY	OPERATIONAL MECHANISM	PRIMARY PRIMARY SCHOOL PEDAGOGICAL FUNCTION
Reading Aloud (সম্বৰ পাঠ)	Vocalizing written graphemes into acoustic phonemes with correct pronunciation, pitch, and phrasing.	Develops phonemic fluency, auditory self-monitoring, and speech audibility in lower primary classes.

Silent Reading (নীৰৱ পাঠ)	Visual decoding directly to mental concepts without vocal cord vibration or lip movement.	Maximizes reading speed, reflective concentration, and mature cognitive comprehension.
Intensive Reading	Close, granular analytical study of short, complex texts focusing on syntactic structure and grammar.	Deconstructing grammatical rules, lexical nuances, and specific detailed text propositions.
Extensive Reading	Reading large volumes of accessible, enjoyable literature (storybooks, comics) for global pleasure.	Cultivates autonomous reading habits, sight-word automaticity, and broad vocabulary exposure.

● **THE FOUR TEXT GENRES IN ELEMENTARY SCHOOL DISCOURSE:**

1. Descriptive Texts

Presents detailed sensory characteristics of people, animals, places, or objects using rich spatial adverbs and adjectives (e.g., "A Monsoon Day in Majuli").

2. Narrative Texts

Chronicles sequential events occurring across chronological time, featuring setting, character motivations, conflict, climax, and emotional resolution.

3. Expository Texts

Communicates factual, objective scientific or historical knowledge through cause-effect, compare-contrast, and logical classifications (e.g., "How Plants Make Food").

4. Persuasive Texts

Constructs argumentative rhetoric and presents evidentiary claims to convince the reader to adopt a specific belief, attitude, or civic behavior.

3.3 &
3.4

The Three-Phase Instructional Reading Model & Goodman's Miscue Analysis

Reading
Diagnostics

The Three-Phase Instructional Reading Model:

Transforming reading instruction from mechanical calling of words into an active comprehension journey:

1. Pre-Reading (Schema Activation):

Predicting story events from the title and cover illustrations; connecting the theme to personal life; pre-teaching 2-3 critical vocabulary bottleneck words.

2. While-Reading (Active Engagement):

Silent reading with guiding prompt questions; confirming or revising predictions; self-monitoring comprehension; annotating confusing lines.

3. Post-Reading (Integration & Extension):

Critical discussion, character role-play, drawing emotional scenes, dramatization, and creative alternate ending composition.

Kenneth Goodman's Miscue Analysis:

Linguist Kenneth Goodman revolutionized literacy assessment by redefining oral reading errors as "**Miscues**"—diagnostic windows into the reader's three subconscious cueing systems:

• **Graphophonic Miscue (Visual Cue):** Reading "horse" as "house". The child relies excessively on similar letter shapes while ignoring context.

• **Syntactic Miscue (Grammar Cue):** Reading "The dog ran" as "The dog walked". The grammar and part of speech fit perfectly, though the word differs.

• **Semantic Miscue (Meaning Cue):** Reading "The king sat on his horse" as "The king sat on his pony". The visual word differs, but the fundamental meaning is 100% preserved!

Pedagogical Directive: Never interrupt or penalize semantic miscues! They demonstrate that the child is actively comprehending text meaning rather than barking at letters.

4

Vocabulary in Context and Word Architecture

Open vs. Closed Classes, Morphological Affixation, Lexical Semantics & Multi-Word Expressions

Weightage: 10 Marks

4.1 &
4.2

Lexical Taxonomy: Open-Class Content Words vs. Closed-Class Function Words

Grammatical
Architecture

In contemporary structural linguistics, a language's vocabulary is not an arbitrary flat list. Words operate within two fundamentally distinct systemic categories based on their semantic weight and structural flexibility:

EVALUATIVE FEATURE	OPEN-CLASS WORDS (CONTENT WORDS)	CLOSED-CLASS WORDS (FUNCTION / STRUCTURE WORDS)
Constituent Parts of Speech	Nouns, Lexical Main Verbs, Adjectives, Descriptive Adverbs (e.g., <i>classroom, sprint, luminous, quietly</i>).	Pronouns, Prepositions, Conjunctions, Determiners, Auxiliary Verbs (e.g., <i>she, under, although, the, could</i>).
Membership Influx	Infinite and Dynamic: Constantly assimilates new coinages and loan words (e.g., <i>selfie, download, internet, vlog</i>).	Finite and Fixed: Resists new coinages. The set of English prepositions or auxiliary verbs rarely admits new members.
Semantic Payload	Carries the primary informational meaning, propositional content, and sensory imagery of an utterance.	Provides grammatical syntax and relational mortar connecting content words together.

Phonetic Prosody

Typically articulated with full phonetic value and receive **sentence stress** in natural connected speech.

Typically unstressed in running speech and pronounced in their weakened vowel forms (e.g., to as /tə/, and as /ən/).

4.3 & 4.4

Morphology, Affixation Engines & Compounding

Word Formation

Morphological Affixation (Prefixes vs. Suffixes):

A **Root / Base** is the irreducible core carrying fundamental lexical meaning. Affixes attach to generate morphological variants:

Prefixation:

Affixes attached before the root (frequently alters semantic meaning without altering grammatical class):

un- [not] + happy [Adj] = unhappy [Adj]
dis- [reversal] + honest [Adj] = dishonest [Adj]

Derivational vs. Inflectional Suffixes:

- **Derivational Suffixes:** Transform grammatical category or create distinct lexical identities:

teach [Verb] + -er = teacher [Noun]
beauty [Noun] + -ful = beautiful [Adjective]

- **Inflectional Suffixes:** Mark grammatical tense, number, or comparison without changing word class:

play → plays, played, playing [always Verbs]

Compounding & Noun Phrase Modifiers:

Compounding (যৌগিক শব্দ গঠন):

Fusing two or more independent free roots to generate a single composite lexical unit:

black [Adj] + board [Noun] = blackboard [Noun]
sun [Noun] + flower [Noun] = sunflower [Noun]

Pre-Modifiers vs. Post-Modifiers:

Structural elements expanding or restricting a head noun: • **Pre-modifier:** Appears before head noun ("A [clever, industrious] student").

- **Post-modifier:** Appears after head noun as prepositional phrase or relative clause ("The student [with the blue satchel who scored highest]").

4.5

Semantic Relationships, Multi-Word Chunks & Figurative Idioms

Lexical Semantics

1. SYNONYMS & ANTONYMS

Synonyms: Words sharing near-equivalent denotations (e.g., enormous / gigantic). True absolute synonyms are rare due to differing registers!

Antonyms: Relational opposites (e.g., hot / cold, buy / sell, alive / dead).

2. HOMOPHONES VS. HOMOGRAPHS

- **Homophones:** Identical sound, differing spelling & meaning (*sun / son, sea / see, write / right*).
- **Homographs:** Identical spelling, differing sound & meaning (*lead /li:d/ (guide) vs. lead /led/ (metal)*).
- **Homonyms:** Identical sound AND spelling, differing meaning (*bank (river) vs. bank (money)*).

3. PHRASAL VERBS & COLLOCATIONS

- **Phrasal Verbs:** Idiomatic verb + particle combinations (*give up, look after, carry out*).
- **Idioms:** Metaphorical expressions whose meaning cannot be deduced literally ("*break a leg*", "*piece of cake*").
- **Collocations:** Natural habitual pairings of words (*fast food NOT quick food; make an effort NOT do an effort*).

PAPER S1.5 CONTINUOUS INTERNAL ASSESSMENT BLUEPRINT

Total: 15 Internal Marks • Practical Verification, Material Design & Profile Submission

Session 2026

Practicum Tasks & Individual Profile Submission

10 Marks

LSRW Material Design + Reflective Journals

Institutional Written Unit Test

5 Marks

Evaluates Theoretical & Linguistic Mastery

PRESCRIBED PRACTICUM ASSIGNMENT TASKS:

- **LSRW Material Design Workshop (5 Marks):** Design, fabricate, and demonstrate innovative, zero-cost teaching-learning materials (TLMs) engineered specifically to develop Listening, Speaking, and Reading comprehension in primary school learners.
- **Textbook Lexicon & Phonics Audit (5 Marks):** Collect sample passages from Class 1 to 5 SCERT English textbooks; categorize words into open vs. closed classes; construct minimal pair phonetic contrast cards to eliminate mother-tongue phonetic interference.
- **Cumulative Trainee Portfolio:** Compile an organized individual profile documenting all classroom spoken dialogues, dramatic scripts, reading discourse evaluations, and phonetic charts across the semester.
- **Reflective Journal:** Maintain a continuous personal log documenting authentic pedagogical encounters, vocabulary breakthroughs, and self-efficacy growth.

SCHOOL INTERNSHIP LINKAGE (SIP-I – 2 WEEKS):

During School Internship-I, student-teachers observe children's spontaneous oral English attempts, analyze reading errors using Kenneth Goodman's miscue analysis framework, construct an active "Word Wall" inside the primary classroom, and compile an analytical observation report countersigned by the school head teacher.

Paper S1.5 Master Study Notes • Curriculum Session 2026

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